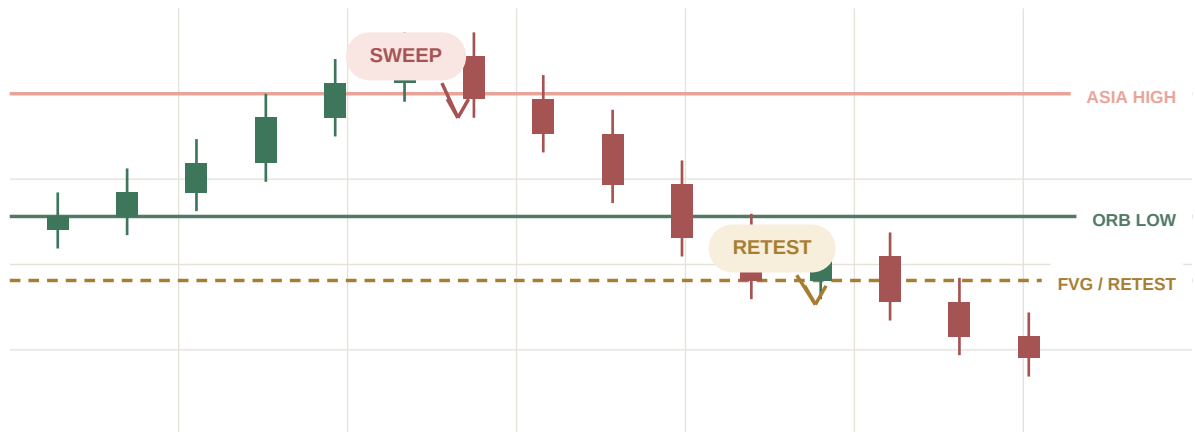


ORB + ICT

Forex Trading Guide

Bias. Liquidity. Displacement. Retest. Execute.



Built for

EURUSD / GBPUSD / USDJPY / GBPJPY / XAUUSD / USDZAR

Primary stack

4H bias -> 1H narrative -> 15M range -> 5M entry

AFRICA/JOHANNESBURG (SAST) | VERSION 1.0 | 05 AUG 2026

A mechanical framework for planning and review - not a reason to force a trade.

1

BIAS

4H

Mark weekly/daily levels. Decide bullish, bearish, or neutral. Do not predict the session path.

2

NARRATIVE

1H

Locate liquidity: PDH/PDL, Asia high/low, equal highs/lows, and major 1H/4H FVGs.

3

RANGE

15M

Build the London or New York opening range. Wait until the range candle closes.

4

ENTRY

5M

Require displacement, a close beyond the boundary, and a controlled retest. 1M is optional refinement.

THE 20-SECOND TEST

Can you state this trade in one sentence?

A named level was swept, price displaced through a confirmed ORB boundary, the retest held, and the next clean liquidity target pays at least 3R.

- If one clause is missing: wait.
- If the story changes: invalidate, do not reinterpret.
- If two correlated trades express the same USD view: treat them as one risk bucket.

Johannesburg trading times

SAST stays UTC+2. London and New York move by one hour during daylight saving.

TODAY'S REFERENCE - 05 AUG 2026

Both London and New York are on summer time



Suggested ORB = first 15 minutes after the named open. For XAUUSD, also watch the 15:30 SAST US cash-market impulse; it is not the COMEX daily open.

REFERENCE	SUMMER SAST	WINTER SAST	USE
Asia range (00:00-08:00 London)	01:00-09:00	02:00-10:00	Range
London cash open / 15M ORB	09:00 / 09:00-09:15	10:00 / 10:00-10:15	Primary EUR/GBP
New York midnight open	06:00	07:00	Daily reference
New York FX open / 15M ORB	14:00 / 14:00-14:15	15:00 / 15:00-15:15	Primary USD
NYSE core open / 15M ORB	15:30 / 15:30-15:45	16:30 / 16:30-16:45	Gold / indices
London cash close	17:30	18:30	Liquidity shift

DST CHECK - DO THIS EVERY MONDAY

- Set chart time zones to Europe/London and America/New_York - not fixed GMT offsets.
- 2026 US DST: 08 Mar-01 Nov. UK DST: 29 Mar-25 Oct. Mismatch weeks shift the overlap.
- Holiday and early-close days can change liquidity even when the clock time is correct.

FX session windows are analysis conventions; FX itself is decentralized. Exchange opens are anchors, not guaranteed volatility.

Build the liquidity map

Mark fewer levels, then define what price must do at them.



LEVEL ORDER

1 External liquidity

PWH / PWL, PDH / PDL, equal highs / lows

2 Session liquidity

Asia H/L, London ORB, NY ORB

3 Reference prices

Daily open, NY midnight, ORB midpoint

4 Imbalances

Unfilled 1H / 4H FVGs aligned with the story

Do not trade a label.

Trade the reaction and confirmation.

MAKE THE CONCEPTS MECHANICAL

LIQUIDITY SWEEP

Price trades beyond a named high/low, then closes back through it within 1-3 execution candles.

DISPLACEMENT

A wide body closes beyond the ORB boundary, near its extreme, and is visibly larger than recent bodies.

FVG

A three-candle imbalance: candle 1 high and candle 3 low do not overlap (bullish); reverse for bearish.

RETEST

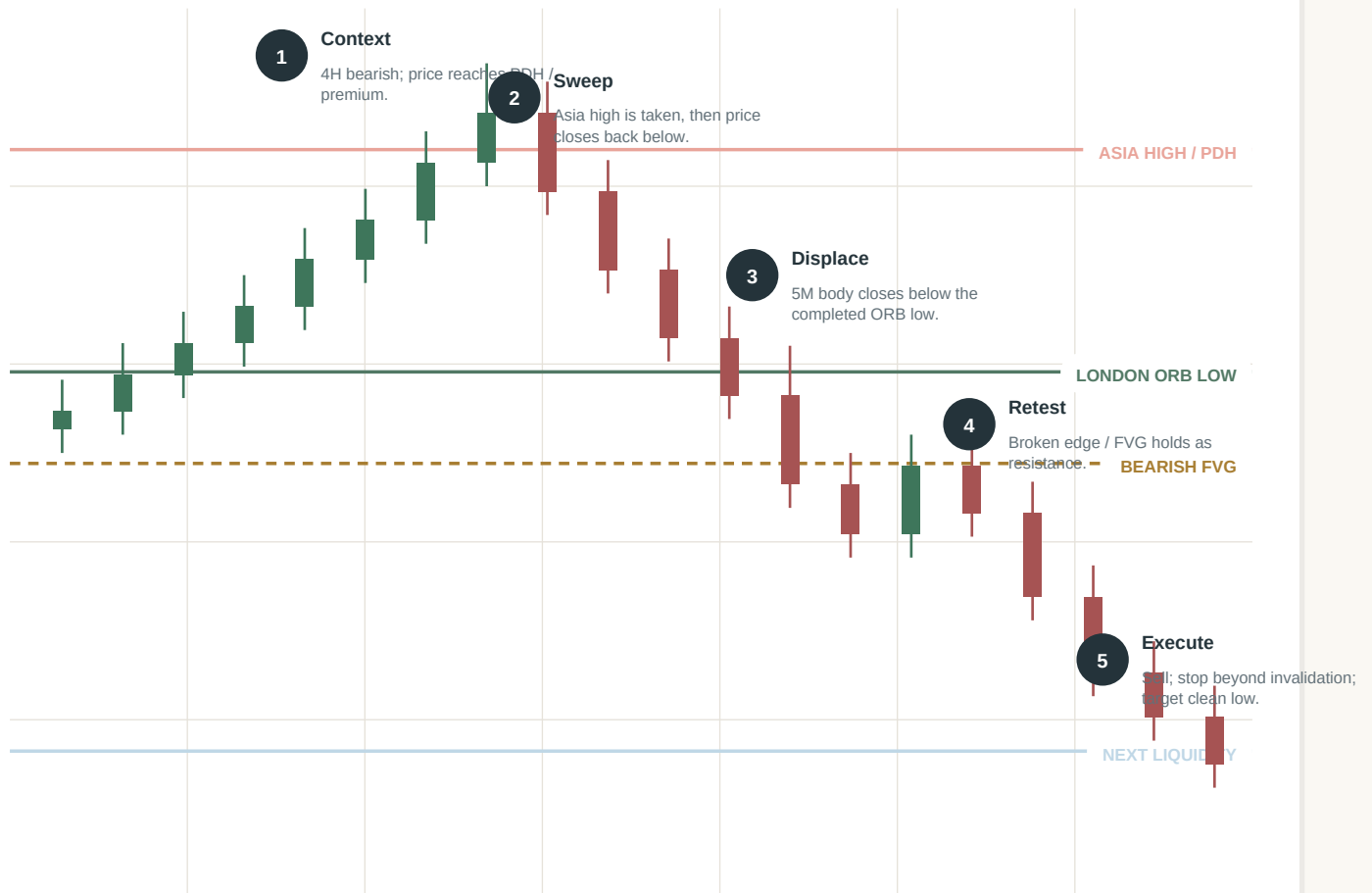
Price revisits the broken ORB edge or displacement FVG, then closes away without reclaiming invalidation.

EQUAL HIGHS / LOWS

Two or more obvious swings at near-identical prices. Use a small ATR-based tolerance; do not demand exact ticks.

Sweep -> ORB reversal

Highest-quality when the sweep occurs into a higher-timeframe level and the breakout has clean space to target.



BEARISH ENTRY RULE

Enter only after the retest rejects. The stop belongs beyond the level that proves the story wrong - not at an arbitrary pip count.

- Trigger: bearish close away from ORB low / FVG after retest.
- Invalidation: acceptance back above the sweep/retest structure.
- Target: next unswept low; must allow at least 3R before opposing liquidity.
- Cancel: no displacement, late chase, or entry straight into nearby support.

ORB continuation after pullback

Use when higher-timeframe direction is already established and the session opens with controlled expansion.



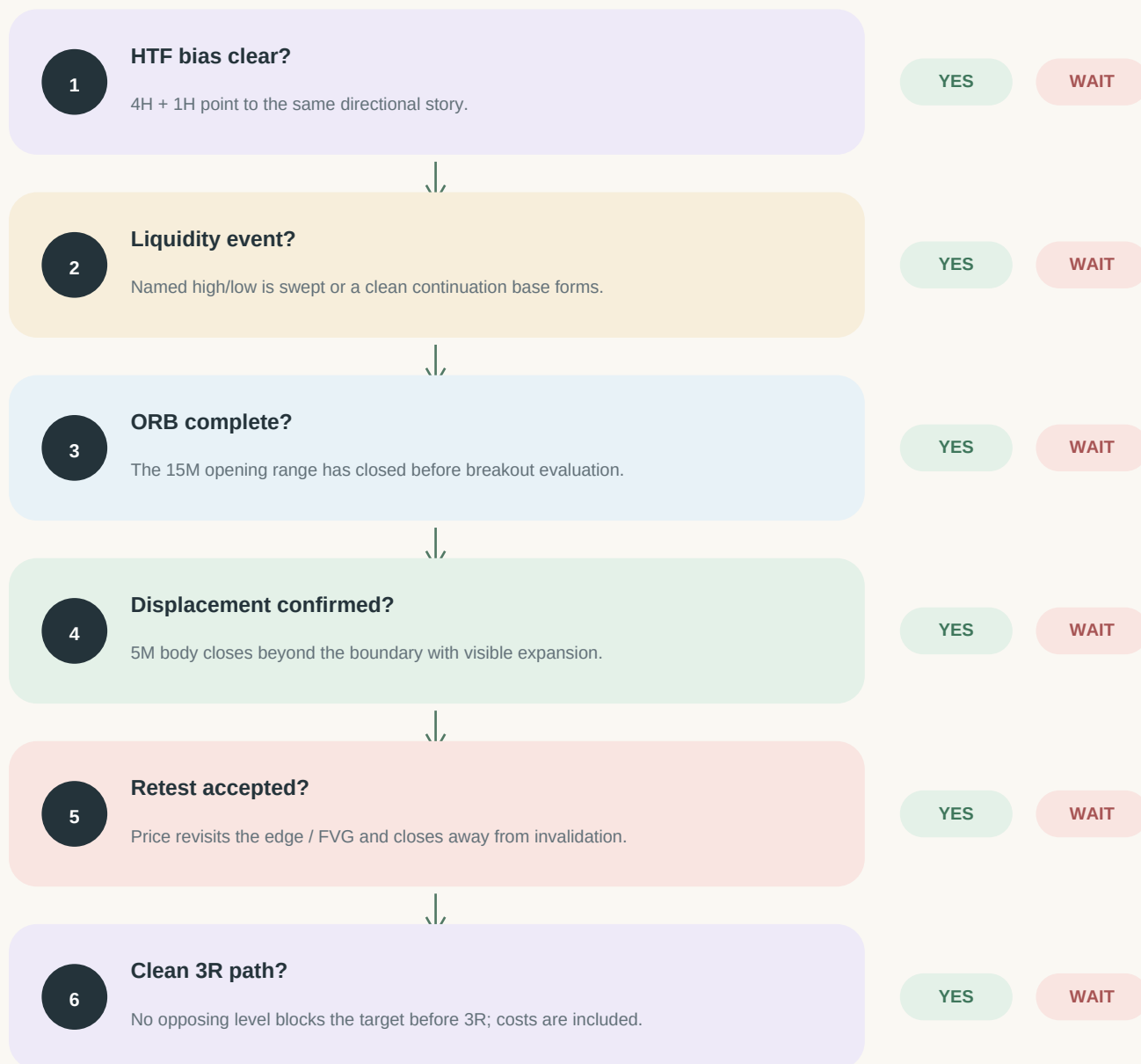
BULLISH ENTRY RULE

The ORB breakout is information, not the entry. The entry is the first clean pullback that proves the broken boundary can hold.

- Context: bullish 4H/1H and no major resistance directly overhead.
- Trigger: 5M rejection after retest; close near the candle high.
- Invalidation: close back inside the ORB with failed follow-through.
- Cancel: breakout candle is already more than 1R from a logical stop.

A-grade setup decision path

A label is earned by confirmed evidence. Developing conditions never count as confirmed.



GRADE

A

6 / 6 confirmed

Eligible. Execute only at planned size.

B

5 / 6 confirmed

Watchlist only. Do not force the missing factor.

AUTOMATIC PASS

ORB incomplete | No close outside | Stop undefined | Target < 3R | Correlated risk already full

Setups to avoid and management rules

Most bad trades are recognizable before entry.

01

WICK-ONLY BREAK

Price crosses the line but closes back inside. A sweep is not a confirmed breakout.

02

MIDDLE OF RANGE

No external liquidity event and no clear invalidation. Reward is usually compressed.

03

LATE CHASE

Entry is far from the ORB edge or FVG; the stop distance consumes the remaining target.

04

NEWS COLLISION

High-impact release is imminent, spread expands, or the first candle is abnormal. Let it settle.

05

DOUBLE USD RISK

EURUSD long plus GBPUSD long is often one USD-short idea twice. Combine risk, do not duplicate it.

06

SESSION EXHAUSTION

The move already swept the target before your entry window. A setup without room is not a setup.

MANAGEMENT - PRECOMMIT BEFORE ENTRY

STOP

Beyond structural invalidation + spread buffer. Never widen after entry.

1R

Do nothing by default. A premature break-even stop often removes valid retests.

2R

Optional partial only if written in the plan; do not improvise from fear.

3R+

Take the planned target or trail behind confirmed 5M structure - choose one method.

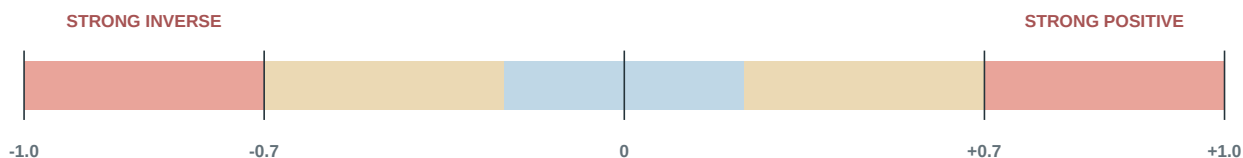
FAILURE

A 5M close through invalidation ends the idea. Exit; do not wait for hope.

Correlation without guesswork

Correlations change. Measure them before combining positions.

USE A 20-DAY CORRELATION CHECK



PRACTICAL RELATIONSHIPS TO CHECK - NOT PERMANENT PROMISES

EURUSD



GBPUSD

Often same USD leg

Pick one or split risk



EURUSD



USDCHF

Often opposite USD expression

Do not count as diversification



XAUUSD



DXY / yields

Regime-dependent

Require live confirmation



GBPJPY



GBPUSD + USDJPY

Cross combines both legs

Trade only when legs agree



USDZAR



DXY + risk tone

Can decouple on SA news

Reduce size; respect spread



ONE RISK-BUCKET RULE

Total open risk across one shared driver must not exceed 2% (\$20 on a \$1,000 account).

- EURUSD long + GBPUSD long: often both are USD short.
- XAUUSD long + EURUSD long: may share USD weakness.
- GBPJPY long needs GBP strength and JPY weakness; conflicting legs reduce quality.

TradingView's Correlation Coefficient uses values from -1 to +1; its default length is 20 periods and the relationship can change.

A few pairs, specific rules

The same framework behaves differently because session liquidity, spread, and drivers differ.

PAIR	TYPE	BEST FOCUS	ORB	PAIR-SPECIFIC RULE
EURUSD	XXXUSD	London + NY FX	15M London	Cleanest when EUR and USD stories agree. Watch EURUSD/GBPUSD duplicate exposure.
GBPUSD	XXXUSD	London + overlap	15M London	More wick-prone. Require a close and retest; avoid using a wick beyond ORB as confirmation.
USDCAD	USDXXX	NY FX	15M NY	Oil / Canada news can override broad USD. Check nearby data and do not assume pure DXY behavior.
USDJPY	USDXXX	Asia + NY	15M NY	Sensitive to yield / JPY repricing. Avoid fading a strong aligned trend without a clear sweep.
GBPJPY	XXXJPY	London	15M London	High range. Require GBP and JPY legs to agree; wider structure means smaller size.
XAUUSD	METAL	NY FX + NYSE	15M NY/NYSE	Use price-distance sizing, not pips. Confirm broker contract size. Expect data-driven slippage.
USDZAR	EXOTIC	London + early NY	30M preferred	Wide/variable spread and local headlines. Use limit entries only if execution is reliable; reduce frequency.

PAIR SELECTION RULE

Scan the set, then trade the chart with the cleanest sweep, cleanest displacement, and clearest 3R path - not the pair you trade from habit.

\$1,000 account / 2% risk

Leverage changes margin required. Your stop distance and position size determine planned loss.

FIXED RISK PER TRADE

\$20

$$= \$1,000 \times 2\%$$

This is the total risk bucket, including correlated positions.

MINIMUM TARGET \$60 / 3R

SIZE LAST - AFTER THE STOP IS KNOWN

Position size = \$20 risk / loss per lot at the stop

EURUSD

10-pip stop; ~\$10/pip per standard lot

$$\$20 / \$100 = 0.20 \text{ lot}$$

EURUSD

15-pip stop; ~\$10/pip per standard lot

$$\$20 / \$150 = 0.13 \text{ lot}$$

XAUUSD

\$5 stop; broker contract = 100 oz / lot

$$\$20 / \$500 = 0.04 \text{ lot}$$

Examples exclude spread/slippage and use common contract conventions. Your broker specification is the final authority.

BEFORE ORDER

- ☐ Entry, stop, and target are written.
- ☐ Spread + expected slippage fit inside \$20.
- ☐ Target pays at least \$60 before opposing liquidity.
- ☐ Position size rounds down to broker step.
- ☐ Existing correlated risk is deducted first.

HARD DAILY GUARDRAILS

- ☐ Maximum one full 2% risk bucket at a time.
- ☐ After -2R in a day: stop and review.
- ☐ No widening stops or adding to losers.
- ☐ No revenge entry after a valid stop-out.
- ☐ If broker sizing is unclear: no order.

1:500 LEVERAGE

is buying-power capacity, not permission to use maximum size. Margin can be small while loss at the stop is still large.

Plan, execute, review

Print this page or recreate it as a TradingView note template.

A PRE-MARKET

- ☐ Economic calendar checked; red-folder times written in SAST.
- ☐ PWH/PWL, PDH/PDL, daily open, NY midnight marked.
- ☐ Asia high/low and major 1H/4H FVGs marked.
- ☐ 4H bias: bullish / bearish / neutral - with one reason.
- ☐ Two clean liquidity targets identified.
- ☐ 20-day correlation checked for candidate pairs.

B SETUP

- ☐ Named liquidity event occurred.
- ☐ 15M ORB is complete; high, midpoint, low marked.
- ☐ 5M displacement closes beyond ORB boundary.
- ☐ Retest holds the boundary / FVG.
- ☐ Entry, invalidation, target, and 3R path are visible.
- ☐ Setup grade is A (6/6), not developing.

C ORDER

- ☐ Dollar risk $\leq$ \$20 after spread and open exposure.
- ☐ Broker contract size and pip/point value verified.
- ☐ Position size rounded down.
- ☐ Stop and target placed with the order.
- ☐ Management rule chosen before clicking buy/sell.

D REVIEW

- ☐ Before/after screenshots saved.
- ☐ Rules followed? yes / no.
- ☐ Result recorded in R, not only dollars.
- ☐ One execution lesson written.
- ☐ No strategy change from one trade; review after 20 samples.

One-page trade plan + sources

Keep the rule set stable; collect enough samples to learn what actually works for you.

TRADE PLAN

A ONLY

DATE / SESSION

PAIR

4H BIAS + WHY

LIQUIDITY SWEEP

ORB USED

ENTRY / STOP / TARGET

SIZE / \$ RISK

SETUP GRADE

POST-TRADE REVIEW

RESULT (R)

RULE FOLLOWED?

BEST DECISION

ONE IMPROVEMENT

DAILY STOP

-2R reached

or two failed executions

Close platform. Save screenshots. Review when calm.

DISCIPLINE > ACTIVITY

SOURCES / REFERENCE NOTES

- 01 **London Stock Exchange - regular trading hours 08:00-16:30 London time**
<https://www.londonstockexchange.com/personal-investing/faqs>
- 02 **NYSE - core session 09:30-16:00 New York time**
https://www.nyse.com/publicdocs/nyse/NYSE_Extended_Hours_Trading_FAQ.pdf
- 03 **CME Group - COMEX gold contract size and trading-hour reference**
<https://www.cmegroup.com/market-regulation/files/gold-futures-and-options-fact-card.pdf>
- 04 **Timeanddate - South Africa does not observe daylight saving time**
<https://www.timeanddate.com/time/change/south-africa>
- 05 **Timeanddate - London and New York 2026 daylight-saving dates**
London DST page | New York DST page
- 06 **TradingView - Correlation Coefficient scale, 20-period default, changing relationships**
<https://www.tradingview.com/support/solutions/43000502022-correlation-coefficient-cc/>

Timing verified 05 Aug 2026. Recheck exchange holidays, broker specifications, spreads, and daylight-saving rules before live use.